

JOE SAIA

Engineering Leader & PhD Economist

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Engineering leader and PhD economist who builds AI-native engineering organizations. Has shipped production AI agents in healthcare and scaled a 26-person team across engineering, data, QA, and IT. Deep experience in EHR integrations, clinical device data, and claims processing.

Key Achievements

- Implemented a HIPAA-compliant AI agent for initial clinical triage of cardiac device transmissions, flagging abnormal readings for clinician review, cutting triage lead time from three days to near real time and freeing 20 FTEs of capacity.
- Built and led a 26-person engineering, data, QA, IT, and Salesforce organization at Rhythm Management Group, reporting to the CEO.
- Improved platform uptime from 85% to over 99% and moved releases from quarterly to biweekly within three months at Rhythm.
- Reduced cloud spend 30% through backend consolidation while improving system performance at Rhythm.

Work Experience

President & Founder

[Unhistoric Acts Foundation](#) | March 2026 – Present

- Founded a 501(c)(3) nonprofit to build Town Crier, a civic-tech platform that makes local government records (agendas, minutes, ordinances) usable by residents, journalists, and AI agents.
- Designed an AI-native engineering process and serve as its architect and final reviewer, with coding agents building against written specs, automating tests, and validating their work end to end.
- Shipped an MCP server backed by a retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) pipeline, so AI agents can search, retrieve, and cite local government records they could not previously reach.
- Continuously test frontier models and agent tooling, and fold what works into the development process.

Head of Engineering

Rhythm Management Group | May 2024 – March 2026

- Private-equity-backed remote cardiac monitoring company. Reported to the CEO and led a fully in-house, 26-person organization across product and platform engineering, QA, support, IT, data analysis, and Salesforce, spanning the United States, Latin America, Europe, and Turkey.

- Managed eight direct reports: a Director of Engineering; a Senior Manager over the product, QA, platform, and support teams; three senior engineers; a data analyst; a Salesforce analyst; and an IT manager.
- Reorganized a legacy waterfall team around ownership and iterative delivery, shortening customer response times and product decision cycles. Raised platform uptime from 85% to over 99% and moved releases from quarterly to biweekly.
- Implemented an AI agent for first-pass clinical triage that flags abnormal cardiac device transmissions for clinician review, cutting lead time from three days to near real time and freeing 20 FTEs of capacity.
- Co-owned the Snowflake, Fivetran, and Sigma BI stack with the VP of Finance, moving executive and operational reporting to self-service dashboards with shared metric definitions.
- Personally built Python ETL from the revenue cycle management vendor into Salesforce and Snowflake, automating claims reconciliation and measuring claims funnel performance.
- Incorporated Claude Code into the engineering process, along with AI PR reviews and shared skills.

Senior Manager of Data & Engineering

Perry Health | May 2022 – May 2024

- Venture-backed healthtech company with a \$35M Series A. Reported directly to the COO, led engineers and data scientists across New York and Europe, and owned the EHR web application and data infrastructure.
- Built the acquisition-to-enrollment funnel with RudderStack, Google Analytics, and Tableau, instrumenting events and running A/B tests to improve conversion.
- Built the claims processing pipeline that let a two-person revenue team manage ~\$1.5M annually at a 74% collections rate, above the industry average for RPM operations.
- Shipped integrations with Abbott, Dexcom, and Surescripts to improve clinical decision-making.

Data Scientist

Perry Health | December 2021 – May 2022

- Migrated Python ETLs to Fivetran and dbt SQL on Amazon Redshift, enabling faster iteration.
- Maintained company-wide Looker reporting to support business decisions and the \$35M Series A raise.

Machine Learning Engineer

Revelio Labs | May 2021 – December 2021

- Engineered an AWS EMR and PySpark pipeline processing one million LinkedIn profiles daily.
- Trained an ensemble model to standardize employer names across LinkedIn profiles.

Senior Research Assistant

Federal Reserve Board of Governors | October 2014 – July 2016

- Designed a 45 TB data lake of NYSE trade data augmented with internally developed indicators.

Education

- **PhD Economics • Columbia University • August 2016 – May 2021**
- **MSc Economics • University College London • September 2013 – September 2014**
- **BS Physics & Economics • Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute • August 2009 – May 2013**

Skills

- Languages and frameworks: Python, SQL, R, Julia, Go, TypeScript, Node.js, React, NestJS
- AI: AI-native development / coding agents, MCP, RAG, Claude Code, Codex, Amp
- Data platforms: Snowflake, Redshift, dbt, Fivetran, AWS EMR, Spark, Lambda
- BI and product analytics: Tableau, Looker, Sigma, executive reporting, self-service dashboards, attribution, conversion and retention analysis, Google Analytics 4